

United Overseas Bank (UOB)

First Take: Trends underwhelm, as NPL formation picks up; stay UW

Our First Take: UOB reported 2Q26 net income of S\$1.48bn, up 10% y/y, 3% q/q and 5% above JPMe. Earnings include non-recurring gains from asset divestments (S\$237mn in our estimate), without which earnings would have been ~7% below our estimates. On a core basis, trends appear underwhelming vs. peers, with NII down 1% q/q and fee income up 5% y/y. NIM declined 8bps q/q to 1.74%, driven by asset repricing. Asset quality metrics disappointed this quarter. While credit costs were in-line with guidance, new NPAs moved up to S\$902mn (~25bps of loans, not annualized), reflecting a downgrade of one RE account. This led to drawdown in NPA coverage to 88% (from 100%), with GP/performing loans coming off to 0.9%. Costs were higher than expected, driven by higher staff costs in the quarter.

Overall, we see this as a weak set of results, with NII, fee, and AQ trends underperforming peers in the quarter. Management guidance likewise appears weaker vs. peers, with low-single-digit loan and fee growth targets for FY26. This should drive relative underperformance. Maintain UW.

Key Positives

Loan growth was better than expected at 5% y/y, 2% q/q. Non-II was helped by asset sales.

Key Negatives/Question Marks

NPA formation moved up. NIM declined 8bps q/q to 1.74%. The bank drew down GP/performing loans to 0.9%.

Likely Changes to Consensus

We expect limited revisions from the Street post results.

Expected Stock Reaction

We expect near-term stock price underperformance.

Conference Call Details

UOB is hosting a media briefing at 8:30am SGT and an analyst briefing at 9:30am SGT today.

Underweight

UOBH.SI, UOB SP

Price (06 Aug 26): S\$43.58

Price Target (Jun-27): S\$35.00



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Table 1: UOB: 2Q26 earnings review

P&L (\$mn)	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26A	2Q26E	YoY	QoQ	JPM
Net Interest Income	2,336	2,265	2,346	2,324	2,297	2,354	-2%	-1%	-2%
Non-Interest Income	1,129	1,133	944	1,099	1,297	1,126	15%	18%	15%
Fee Income	636	615	625	637	665	662	5%	4%	0%
Other Non-II	493	518	319	462	632	464	28%	37%	36%
Operating Revenue	3,465	3,398	3,289	3,423	3,594	3,480	4%	5%	3%
Operating Costs	(1,535)	(1,535)	(1,528)	(1,523)	(1,629)	(1,566)	6%	7%	4%
PPOP	1,930	1,863	1,761	1,900	1,965	1,914	2%	3%	3%
Impairment Charge	(288)	(1,368)	(120)	(210)	(218)	(268)	-24%	4%	-19%
Other Income	(3)	25	35	23	36	24	NM	57%	49%
Pre-Tax	1,639	520	1,677	1,712	1,784	1,671	9%	4%	7%
Net profit	1,338	443	1,410	1,437	1,478	1,402	10%	3%	5%
DPS (\$)	1.10	-	0.71	-	0.88	0.84	-20%	NM	NM
Gross Loans	342,900	351,084	352,180	353,837	361,411	357,151	5%	2%	1%
Deposits	405,076	419,660	425,938	426,731	437,176	433,473	8%	2%	1%
NPA	5,386	5,809	5,440	5,276	5,750	5,538	7%	9%	4%
Total Allowances	4,765	5,787	5,268	5,251	5,056	5,268	6%	-4%	-4%
Change in bps									
NIM	1.91%	1.82%	1.84%	1.82%	1.74%	1.80%	(17)	(8)	(6)
CIR	44.3%	45.2%	46.5%	44.5%	45.3%	45.0%	103	83	34
LDR	84.7%	83.7%	82.7%	82.9%	82.7%	82.4%	(198)	(25)	28
CASA Ratio	56.5%	57.0%	58.4%	57.0%	55.6%	58.2%	(86)	(137)	(261)
Credit Costs (bps)	32	134	19	24	24	30	(8)	1	(6)
NPL Ratio	1.56%	1.60%	1.53%	1.50%	1.60%	1.54%	4	10	6
NPA Coverage	88%	100%	97%	100%	88%	100%	0	(1,200)	(1,200)
CET1 (fully phased-in)	15.2%	14.5%	14.9%	15.2%	15.0%	15.1%	(17)	(20)	(11)

Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan estimates.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

United Overseas Bank (UOB) *(Underweight; Price Target: S\$35.00)*

Investment Thesis

We are UW on UOB.

- UOB has delivered RoE with the least volatility among Singapore banks over the past 20 years. This may change over the next few quarters, as asset quality risks could remain elevated.
- The bank has lagged peers on WM (limited organic and inorganic build in the last 15 years) and on USD-denominated payments/deposits (26% at UOB vs. 40%/34% at DBS/OCBC). These factors, among others, likely led the bank to take too much risk in areas linked to property in Asia and the US over the last decade in a bid to generate better returns. Accordingly, we are witnessing an increase in credit risk from 2025.
- Further, UOB has the largest EM ASEAN exposure among SG banks, at ~21%, which could see higher risk with current oil price moves. We believe this, along with buffers at management target levels (1% GP/performing loans), could lead to a negative surprise on credit costs in a scenario where AQ stress comes through.
- The bank has committed to a 50% payout ratio for regular dividends. Hence, as EPS risk increases, DPS is at risk, as well. This could limit the upside for the stock.
- We expect ROE to be closer to 11% in 1H26 vs. 12-13% in 4Q24/1Q25. We expect the stock to offer a more balanced risk/return trade-off closer to the mean 1-1.1x fwd P/B, which would price in a degree of lingering AQ risks.
- Following increased spend in the last two years, the bank is better positioned to focus on efficiency, in our view, which could pose an upside risk.

Valuation

Our Jun-27 PT of S\$35 is based on a fair P/B of 1.05x with a normalized RoE of 11.3%, a risk-free rate of 4.15%, a cost of capital of 11% and a growth rate of 4.1%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside risks include better-than-expected delivery on AQ, with a sustained normalization of NPA formation and credit costs. On PPoP, the bank's ability to manage wins from its digital investments could lead to positive revisions, and investments coming to fruition earlier than anticipated would pose upside risks to costs. Any acceleration in WM would be positive.

Downside catalysts include credit cost increases, growth and NIM disappointments, and lower-than-expected dividends and buybacks. Higher operating costs would also be a downside catalyst. Higher-than-anticipated digital investment spending could be a drag on profitability.

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United Overseas Bank (UOB) (UOBH.SI, UOB SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$\$)	Price Target (\$\$)
05-Oct-23	N	28.07	28
09-Dec-23	N	27.58	27
13-Mar-24	N	28.28	30
03-Jul-24	N	31.65	32.5
06-Oct-24	N	31.86	34
10-Nov-24	OW	35.69	41
14-Jan-25	OW	36.80	43
23-Mar-25	N	37.95	40
21-May-25	N	35.40	37
13-Jul-25	N	36.86	38
08-Aug-25	N	35.81	36.5
10-Sep-25	UW	35.57	32.5
28-Nov-25	N	33.89	34
25-Jan-26	UW	39.50	34
17-Apr-26	UW	37.52	33
10-Jun-26	UW	38.38	35

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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